(c) The country lacks a suitable kind of ***transport connectivity*** for which super-highways and rural connectivity programmes are today the high priority areas for the government. The private sector is also being encouraged though at present it too seems to have a limited role in this area especially in urban areas and at micro level only.

(d) The development of ***telecommunication*** with all modern means are necessary pre-conditions for the timely development of agriculture sector and for the empowerment of the farmer.

(e) The ***irrigation preparedness*** of India needs grassroot level approach (already part of the Bharat Nirman) and needs a foolproof systemic approach. It becomes specially important once the climate has started showing its vagaries more and more in recent times.

(f) Everything done till date in the area of developing an adequate kind of ***marketing network*** for agricultural products has not been capable of delivering the same. And that is why the profession of agriculture has been failing to emerge as an economic and profitable area for the farmers. We need to restructure and strengthen it right from the grassroot level to the national level. Only then can we internationalise (***globalise***) our agriculture sector.

(g) If there has been any one area which has failed to have the proper care and support of the insurance it has been the agriculture sector. Even after covering all agricultural activities and products under the agricultural insurance scheme (The *National Agricultural Insurance Scheme*, 1999) it has very low penetration basically due to lack of awareness among the farmers/beneficiaries. Now the government is trying hard to do the same which also depends upon suitable level of insurance sector reforms, state governments, care to the sector and awareness among the beneficiaries. At present India has insurance coverage for the crops, seeds. Now there is a proposal to cover even the marketing risk, too.

If we make some **statements** about the SGR, there must not seem any exaggeration in it:

- "The SGR is capable of solving the whole gamut of problems related to Indian food philosophy."